



ROYAL SOLOMON ISLANDS

POLICE FORCE

DIRECT ENTRY RECRUIT PROGRAM

Being a Professional Police Officer

Module 1

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Introduction

The laws of a country must protect the people who live there. The courts and Police must deal with people who break laws. Enforcing the law is very important to the peace, security and freedom of a country. If criminals are free and threaten others, ordinary people cannot live in peace. Democracy dies.

The RSIPF must:

- give excellent service to the people,
- be trusted by the community, and
- be accountable for its actions. (This will be explained later)

All Police officers must be professional. They must be:

- honest,
- fair,
- respectful,
- open, and
- accountable.

All Police officers must do their duty professionally. They must treat everyone fairly. They must act with honour.

The laws of the Solomon Islands give Police 'the power to detain, arrest, search and seize'.

In return all Police officers are expected to:

- uphold the law,
- be ethical, and
- be honest at all times.

'Police officers shall at all times fulfil the duty imposed upon them by law, by serving the community and by protecting all persons against illegal acts, as would be expected of them by the Police Force and their community.'

This means people expect the Police to always:

- do their job;
- serve the community; and
- protect every person from law breakers.

People have a right to live in peace and be safe. They have a right to be treated with dignity. Police officers shall always:

- respect the law;
- obey the law, and
- respect the human rights of every person in the community.

You must prove your personal and professional integrity by your actions as a Police officer.

If you follow the rules, policies, practices, procedures and values of the RSIPF and the law then you will be acting ethically.

In order to become better at your work you should think about your actions each day. You must know:

- what you do best,
- what you need to learn, and
- what you need do better. Think, “How could I do that better?”

Ask senior officers, “How could I have done that better?”

When you are not sure what to do, ask for advice. “In this case, what should I do?”

Professionalism

Law enforcement officials shall at all times fulfil the duty imposed upon them by law, by serving the community and by protecting all persons against illegal acts, as would be expected of them by the Police Force and their community.

This means Police officers must:

- do their duty all of the time;
- serve every person in the community, and
- protect each person from those who break laws.

As a new Police Officer, you must be professional. Be responsible for your own actions. You are accountable to the RSIPF and to the community.

Think about your actions. Make sure that you always behave correctly as a Police Officer. Other officers and the community expect this.

To finish the Recruit Course and the Probationary Constable Program successfully, you must behave correctly, professionally, and in line with RSIPF Standing Orders. Do not commit a crime or break RSIPF rules.

You must show that you understand the policies, practices, procedures and values of the RSIPF, and the law. Show that you are committed to applying them correctly.

Know the law and the RSIPF values, rules and policies. Follow those guidelines. Be professional. Be accountable for your actions.

Police officers are accountable to the community and to the RSIPF.

Police officers are also accountable for the proper and ethical use of resources, and for ethical behaviour on and off the job.

To help officers understand what the RSIPF considers as ethical behaviour, a Code of Ethics has been developed.

The Code of Ethics contains the Mission Statement of the RSIPF as follows:

The MISSION of the Royal Solomon Island Police Force is “Working in partnership with the community; building confidence in the RSIPF, for a safe, peaceful and prosperous Solomon Islands.”

The Code of Ethics also includes the oath by Police to support this Mission Statement in terms of:

Leadership and Goals

“Maintain standards of leadership that are consistent with the mission statement, goals and policies of the RSIPF.”

A Police officer must be a good leader. He/she must always follow the goals and policies of the RSIPF.

Community

“Work in partnership with the community to fight crime, exercising particular sensitivity to victims of crime.”

All Police officers are part of the community. They must help keep the community free of crime. They must help people who have been the victims of crime.

Every law enforcement agency, including the RSIPF, shall be representative of, and responsive and accountable, to the community as a whole.

Integrity

“Act with honesty and with the utmost integrity and not misuse my office for personal gain or participate in any improper or unlawful conduct; I will always uphold high moral values.”

- Be honest.
- Do not use the job to get things for yourself.
- Do not break any laws.
- Be proper and moral.

Law enforcement officers shall not be corrupt. They shall also work against anyone who is breaking a law.

- (a) “Any act of corruption is an abuse of authority. Police officers must not be corrupt. Any Police official who commits an act of corruption must be charged. Governments cannot enforce the law among their citizens if they cannot, or will not, enforce the law against their own agents and within their agencies.”
- (b) Corruption is defined by the law. It includes:
 - doing things that are against the law;
 - not enforcing the law;
 - taking gifts or bribes from people who have broken the law;
 - asking for gifts or bribes from people who have broken a law, or
 - even asking for a gift from someone in return for doing your job.
- (c) A Police officer can also act corruptly by not doing his duty when a wantok is involved in a crime.

Discipline and Professionalism

“Practice discipline in words and deeds, on and off duty, strive for excellence and endeavour to improve my knowledge and professionalism.”

- Think before you act or speak.
- Do your best.
- Read and learn more.
- Be a professional.

“All Police action shall respect the rule of law, principles of ethics, necessity, non–discrimination, and humanity.”

“Police officers should report any other Police officer who breaks the law, codes and sets of principles which protect and promote human rights.”

The Professional Standards and Internal Investigations (PSII) investigate disciplinary offences.

Human Rights

“Respect and uphold the rights of all people in the community regardless of ethnic origin, gender or religion.”

The constitution gives every person the same rights and freedoms. It does not matter:

- where they come from,
- what church they go to,
- what language they speak, or
- if they are men or women

The Police must treat them the same and protect their rights.

Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment is not acceptable. No member of the RSIPF should be sexually harassed at work.

Sexual Harassment can be one action or can happen many times. Sexual Harassment is being picked on because of your sex. It can be:

- unwanted sexual attention. It is particularly bad when it keeps happening after you make it clear that you find it offensive and not acceptable;
- trying to start a sexual relationship with someone when they do not want to;
- suggestions that sexual favours may help your career (or their refusal will prevent or delay it), and
- actions of a sexual nature that make the workplace stressful.

Verbal Sexual Harassment includes:

- using sexually explicit profanity; that means swearing using sex words;
- telling jokes about sex;
- threats;
- sexual comments;
- referring to a person's behaviour or physical appearance in a sexual way;
- talking about a person's body;
- using words that are normally only used for close or intimate relationships, that means words that you would only use with your sex partner.

Non-verbal Sexual Harassment includes:

- staring at someone;
- putting up pictures, cartoons or calendars showing women in a sexual way; and
- sending email messages or notes with sexual messages.

Physical Sexual Harassment includes:

- touching,
- kissing,
- grabbing, and
- blocking a hallway.

Sexual assault and rape are the worst forms of sexual harassment. They are serious criminal acts.

Harassment could be from:

- a supervising officer toward a constable,
- a constable to another constable,
- a Police officer to a civilian, or
- a Police officer towards a recruit. Harassment can also happen away from work.

Does it only happen to women?

Although most victims are women, sexual harassment does happen to men. It causes men the same pain and stress.

How does a victim feel?

Sexual Harassment can make a person feel:

- threatened,
- inferior, and
- shamed.

How can we prevent and stop Sexual Harassment?

All members of the RSIPF can prevent sexual harassment. Police officers should:

- understand the RSIPF Sexual Harassment in the Workplace Policy;
- know what harassment is;
- attend training;
- make sure that you do not offend someone;
- make sure others do not mistake what you are saying;
- say “No,” to someone who is harassing you, and
- help others who are being sexually harassed at work.

What to do when sexual harassment happens?

- Talk to a person who is sexually harassing another person.
- Explain that the behaviour is not accepted and not wanted, or
- Tell them to stop.

You may need a friend or colleague with you when you do this. If you do not want to speak to the person, you can write to him/her.

What to do if harassment does not stop?

- Report incidents to your supervisor or the Welfare Unit.
- If it is your immediate supervisor who is harassing you, speak to someone of higher rank or the Welfare Unit.
- Ask for help so the harassment stops; or
- File a formal complaint

Professional Standards and Internal Investigations Directorate will then look at the complaint and see if discipline action will begin.

Sexual Harassment makes a person:

- feel shame
- feel sick in the head.
- feel sick in the stomach
- not be able to work well because they worry too much
- not want to come to work
- ask for a transfer or quit working for the RSIPF because they can no longer work at the post;
- denies equal rights and good working conditions.

The RSIPF will not tolerate sexual harassment. Cases of harassment will be dealt with under the Policy and Guidelines for Members of the RSIPF in dealing with Breaches of Discipline and Complaints against Police.

Confidentiality

“Keep confidential all matters that I may learn in my official capacity, except as necessary in the course of my duties.”

“Matters of a confidential nature in the possession of law enforcement officials shall be kept confidential, unless the performance of duty or the needs of justice strictly require otherwise.”

While doing your job, you will learn many things. Some things must be used to enforce the law. Talking to Police officers working on the case is correct. Talking to other Police not working on the case is wrong.

Some of this information is private. If you talk to others, you could hurt the reputation of the person. Be professional. Do not gossip.

“You commit a disciplinary offence if you without due authority disclose or convey any information concerning any investigation or any other matter with which you are concerned in the course of your duties as a Police officer.”

Impartiality and Fairness

“Carry out my duties without favour or affection, malice or ill will.”

You should treat all people the same. Everyone is equal according to the law. Do not discriminate because of:

- race,
- colour,
- sex,
- language,
- religion,
- political or other opinion,
- national or social origin,
- property,
- birth or other status.

Respect the religious and moral beliefs of others.

Responsibility and Accountability

“Accept responsibility for my own actions and for acts that I may order.”

Resource Management/Customer Service

“Make efficient and economical use of public resources and provide conscientious, effective, efficient and courteous service to all with whom I have dealings.”

- Do not waste.
- Do not take things home with you.
- Don't use Police cars to go take your children to school.
- Don't take parts off of the car.

The government must use its money to help all people of the country. Do not waste public resources.

Give good service to all people who come to you for help. Be polite. Do your job well. Do your job quickly.

Code of Ethics

RSIPF MISSION STATEMENT is working in partnership with the community; building confidence in the RSIPF, for a safe, peaceful and prosperous Solomon Islands.

I, as a member of the Royal Solomon Islands Police Force, support this Mission Statement and will:

LEADERSHIP/GOALS Maintain standards of leadership that are consistent with the mission statement, goals and policies of the RSIPF.	COMMUNITY Work in partnership with the community to fight crime, exercising particular sensitivity to victims of crime.
INTEGRITY Act with honesty and with the utmost integrity and not misuse my office for personal gain or participate in any improper or unlawful conduct; I will always uphold high moral values.	DISCIPLINE/PROFESSIONALISM Practice discipline in words and deeds, on and off duty; strive for excellence and endeavour to improve my knowledge and professionalism.
HUMAN RIGHTS Respect and uphold the rights of all people in the community regardless of ethnic origin, gender or religion.	CONFIDENTIALITY Keep confidential all matters that I may learn in my official capacity, except as necessary in the course of my duties.
IMPARTIALITY/FAIRNESS Carry out my duties without favour or affection, malice or ill will.	RESPONSIBILITY/ ACCOUNTABILITY Accept responsibility for my own actions and for acts that I may order.
RESOURCE MANAGEMENT/CUSTOMER SERVICE Make efficient and economical use of public resources and provide conscientious, effective, efficient and courteous service to all with whom I have dealings.	

I ACCEPT THE DESIRABILITY OF THESE ETHICS AS AN INTEGRAL PART OF MY PERSONAL AND PROFESSIONAL LIFE.

Ethics

Ethics is concerned with the principles of 'right' behaviour.

Ethics help us do the right thing. We learn ethics from our family, our church and our society. At work, if there are no rules or if the rule is not clear, ethics can help us decide what is the right thing to do and when to do it.

No matter what happens, you must always act ethically.

All members of the Police force must work together to give services to the community. Police must serve people and make people believe that Police will keep them safe.

You are a professional. Try to be:

- fair
- impartial (Treat all people the same.)
- diligent (Hard working.)
- efficient (Work quickly and well.)
- act with integrity (Be honest.)

Police officers are watched by the public, even when they are off duty. Your behaviour at home and at work should make the community respect you. It should make the community confident about you and other Police.

You are expected to behave ethically while working and while off-duty.

- Be accountable for your actions always.
- Admit to what you do. It is part of being a professional.

When officers are ethical and accountable, they can feel proud of themselves and the Police service. The public have confidence in the Police.

Your training teaches you how to be ethical and what to do in some situations. Knowing what to do will help you to be more professional.

Developing Ethical Attitudes in the RSIPF

The Code of Ethics of the RSIPF tells Police how to behave. It sets high standards for ethical behaviour.

Training so Police know how to act ethically also helps. Everyone in the RSIPF must be ethical at all times.

Unethical Behaviour

The RSIPF has worked hard to teach ethics to its officers. However, you may still meet officers who are not always ethical.

The choice is yours – to act ethically or unethically.

The choice is yours – to remain in the RSIPF or to be dismissed.

If you choose to act unethically during the Recruit Course or the Probationary Constable Program, then you will be dealt with swiftly.

Police Regulations

Section 72 of the Police Regulations (Ch 110) give the follow grounds for dismissal. (Actions that are not allowed and will cause you to be fired)

<i>Regulation</i>	<i>Easy words</i>
(a) Is disrespectful in word, act or demeanour to any of his/her superior officers;	Does not show respect to a senior officer;
(b) Disobeys a lawful order to apprehend or to assist in the apprehension of any	Won't arrest someone when lawfully ordered to do so;
(c) Wilfully disobeys any lawful orders;	Does not follow orders;
(d) Is guilty of drunkenness;	Is drunk;
(e) Renders himself/herself unfit for duty through intoxication;	Cannot work because he/she has been drinking or using drugs;
(f) Without cause fails to appear or appears late for duty;	Does not come to work or is late for work;
(g) Sleeps at his/her post or leaves his/her post before he/she is relieved, except in fresh pursuit of an offender whom it is his/her duty to apprehend;	Sleeps at work or leaves work; (You can leave work to chase a person who has committed an offence and whom you have grounds to arrest)
(h) Being under arrest or in confinement leaves or escapes from his/her arrest or confinement before he/she is set at liberty by proper authority;	Escapes when you are under arrest;
(i) Negligently allows any prisoner who is committed to his/her charge, or whom it is his/her duty to keep or guard, to escape	Lets a prisoner escape;
(j) Offers or uses unwarranted personal violence to or ill treats any person in his/her custody;	Hurts a prisoner;
(k) Is guilty of cowardice;	Is a coward. Is too frightened to work;
(l) Discharges any arms without just cause or contrary to orders;	Fires a gun for no good reason;
(m) Pawns, sells, loses by neglect, makes away with, wilfully damages or fails to report any damage to arms, ammunition, equipment, clothing or other appointments supplied to him/her or any other public property committed to his/her charge;	Sells or loses Police property; Doesn't report damage to Police property;
(n) Is slovenly, inattentive, uncivil or quarrelsome;	Is dirty, lazy, rude or angry;

Regulation**Easy words**

- | | |
|--|---|
| (o) Parades for duty dirty or untidy in his/her person, arms, clothing or equipment; | Comes to work dirty or messy; |
| (p) Without due authority discloses or conveys any information concerning any investigation or any other matter with which he/she is concerned in the course of his/her duties as a Police officer; | Talks about a case he/she is working on; |
| (q) Malingers, or feigns or wilfully produces any disease or infirmity; | Is lazy or pretends to be sick; |
| (r) Is guilty of wilful misconduct, or wilfully disobeys any order, by which misconduct or disobedience he/she produces or aggravates any disease or infirmity or delays its cure; | Makes him sick or won't take medicine; |
| (s) Incurs debt beyond his/her means; | Owes people money; |
| (t) Resists or escapes from an escort whose duty it is to apprehend him/her or have him/her charged; | Escapes arrest; |
| (u) Breaks out of any Police quarter or station in which he/she has been lawfully confined; | Escapes from jail; |
| (v) Wilfully makes any false statement upon joining the Police Force; | Lies when joining the Police Force; |
| (w) In the course of his/her duty, wilfully makes a statement which is false in a material particular; | Lies in a legal statement; |
| (x) Refuses or neglects to make or send a report or return which is his/her duty to make or send; | Does not send in reports; |
| (y) Knowingly makes a false accusation against any Police officer or any other person; | Accuses a person falsely; |
| (z) In making a complaint against any other Police officer or any other person, makes a statement affecting the character of such Police officer or other person knowing such statement to be false, or knowingly or wilfully suppresses any material fact in making any such complaint; does not give a true statement of his money, businesses and land when asked to do so; | Lies about another Police officer or anyone else; or hides the truth. |

Regulation

Easy words

- | | |
|--|--|
| (aa) Engages in any trade, business, employment or office outside the scope of his/her Police duties without the authority of the Commissioner; | Runs a business without permission; |
| (bb) Takes any active part in any political organisation or electoral campaign or engages in any other activity which is likely to interfere with the impartial discharge of his/her duties as a Police officer; | Gets involved in politics or anything that could stop the officer being fair; |
| (cc) Becomes security for any person or engages in any loan transaction with any | Guarantees a loan for someone without written permission from the Commissioner; |
| (dd) If called upon by any gazetted officer [i.e., Commissioned Officer] to furnish a full and true statement of his/her financial position, fails to do so; or | Does not give a true statement of his money, businesses and land when asked to do so, or |
| (ee) Is guilty of any other act, conduct, disorder or neglect to the prejudice of good order and discipline. | Does anything else that could break a law or affect discipline. |

As provided for by section 72 of the Police Regulations (Ch. 110) '[a]ny Police officer who does these things "shall be guilty of an offence against discipline for the purpose of section 34."' For further clarification read section 17 of the RSIPF Standing Orders.

If you see another officer commit an unethical act, you must report him or her.

Wise people try to learn and grow every day. They look for ways to do a better job. During the Recruit Course and the Probationary Constable Program you must follow the rules and standards in the RSIPF Standing Orders. You must be moral and ethical at all times.

The Code of Ethics states: 'Practice discipline in words and deeds, on and off duty; strive for excellence and endeavour to improve my knowledge and professionalism.'

Think before you speak or act whether you are at work or off duty.

- Try to be the best you can be.
- Try to learn more.
- Be professional at all times.

You need to think about your behaviour. Decide if you are being ethical.

- Do you follow all the rules in the Standing Orders?
- What are your personal strengths and weaknesses? (What do you do best? What things do you need to do better?)

You can learn a lot by sitting down and thinking about what you have done. You also can learn by watching what a good Police officer does.

- Think 'How can I do better?'
- Ask an experienced officer or an Academy staff, 'How can I do better?'

Review and Monitor own Personal Performance

For the rest of the Probationary Constable Program your actions and performance will be assessed by the training officers. You must have a good assessment to stay in the programme.

You are expected to monitor your performance. Look at:

- your work;
- your uniform;
- how you act with others; and
- how you do the job.

Make a plan to get better. Use the Self Check questions at the end of each unit to help you.

When you start your Plan to Improve you need to:

- think about what you do not understand; and
- think about what you can do to get better.

For example, if you think you do not understanding Police powers, you should read the notes again. Then ask an Academy instructor to answer any questions that you may still have.

Ask for advice whenever you are not sure.

Operational Skills

If you have skills, you know how to do something and can do it well. 'Operational Skills' are about what you can do on the job. An officer with skills knows:

- what to do;
- when to do it; and
- how to do it.

During the Probationary Constable Program people will watch to see if you are becoming a Police officer who has skills. They will look to see if you are learning proper policing activities.

To be thought of as able you need to practice your policing skills as outlined in the Probationary Constable Program Workbook.

The purpose of the Probationary Constable Program is to help you develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes that you will need as a junior officer of the RSIPF. You will be judged on how well you do this.

Help and Support other Personnel

A good Police officer helps and supports other people at work. He/she:

- helps officers who are have too much work to do;
- gives advice when others are confused or not sure what to do;
- listens to and tries to understand others; and
- works with the team.

To make a good workplace all officers and administrators need to work well with each other.

To build good relationships at work you need to:

- be interested. Have a high energy level. Be enthusiastic.
- listen to others before giving your point of view;
- know your own skills;
- ask for advice when necessary;
- admit to your own mistakes. Learn from your mistakes and the mistakes of other officers, and
- be true to yourself. Be open and honest with yourself and with others.

Keep Physical and Emotional Health

During the Recruit Course and the Probationary Constable Program, you must stay healthy. Your physical and emotional health will be checked.

Physical Health

You must be healthy to have the energy you need to do your job every day. It is harder to do shift work, to stay awake at work, and to deal with the difficulties of your job when you are not healthy.

Being fit will also help you deal with the stress on the job. (See the section below on Stress) Smoking and chewing betel nut will not help you cope with the stresses of the job. Both make it harder for you to stay healthy and fit.

Keep healthy. Play sport and exercise with your friends to keep fit.

Emotional Health

Good health is more than not getting sick. You also must have a healthy mind and healthy emotions.

You will feel sick in your head when you:

- worry too much,
- are afraid,
- are angry, or
- plan revenge.

Emotional problems can make it hard to work well.

You will be checked at work to see if your emotions are stopping you from working well. Ask for help when you need it. The Welfare Section can help you find ways to solve personal problems.

Stress Management

Everyone has felt 'stress' at some time. We feel it when we are threatened or worried or when there are big changes in our lives.

Stress happens at work or at home. We feel it when we play sport, too.

We must know what our body is feeling. We must also learn when stress is having a bad effect on our lives.

Stress can be caused by one very scary thing, or it can build up from many stressful things over a long time.

Stress Factors (Things that Make Us Feel Stress)

Some common things that cause stress are:

- the environment, including:
 - o noise;
 - o temperature extremes; (being too hot or too cold)
 - o bad lights, and
 - o dirt.
- social, including
 - o fights with the family;
 - o fights at work;
 - o having too many people in a small space, and
 - o working with angry people, and
- personality, including:
 - o hoping that you will get a lot of things;
 - o wanting to be liked;
 - o worrying about your skills (can I do the job), and
 - o being hurt by someone criticizing you.

People react differently to these things.

Symptoms of Stress

You need to know when your body feels stress. If you know the first signs of stress, you can act quickly and stop it or keep it little.

People react to stress in different ways. Some reactions are very common. These can be put into four groups.

- physical, including:
 - o not being able to rest/relax;
 - o not sleeping well;
 - o eating too little or too much;
 - o tense muscles;
 - o feeling tired;
 - o feeling sick in the stomach, and
 - o feeling sick in the head;
- mental, including:
 - o not being able to concentrate on things;
 - o forgetting things;
 - o making poor decisions, and
 - o less confidence in yourself;
- emotional, including:
 - o bad dreams;
 - o worrying;
 - o feeling tense;
 - o feeling sad;
 - o being very tense;
 - o being angry;
 - o quick changes in mood, and
 - o not wanting to start to do things; and
- behavioural, including:
 - o fights with workmates, family and friends;
 - o drinking too much;
 - o using drugs,
 - o using tobacco, betel nut too much, and
 - o not wanting to be with other people.

Coping Strategies (Ways to Deal with Stress)

If you know you are feeling stress, you can find ways to stop the feeling.

There are many ways to stop stress or make stress feeling smaller. Try many ways and see which ones are best for you.

There are three main ways of dealing with stress:

- Where possible, avoid stress. When you are having problems with a person, try not to be near them too much. Do not put yourself into stressful situations.
(Do not use this method as a way to ignore problems. You do need to find ways to make problems better.)
- Prepare yourself for stress. If you know that you are going to be in a stressful situation, then prepare yourself well.
 - o make sure you get enough sleep/rest;
 - o eat a well-balanced diet;
 - o exercise regularly, and
 - o use relaxation techniques before the event; and
- If you cannot change the situation, change your way of thinking about it.

Self-Check

DO YOU UNDERSTAND that:	YES	NO
You must behave with integrity at work and at home.		
You must look for ways to do your job better.		
You must be a good example for other officers and for the community?		
You must be accountable for your behaviour?		
You must keep physically fit.		
You must find ways to keep stress low.		
CAN YOU EXPLAIN:		
The RSIPF Code of Ethics?		
The RSIPF Sexual Harassment in the Workplace Policy?		
What ethics are?		
The purpose of the Probationary Constable Program?		
The importance of building close working relationships at work?		
How to build close working relationships at work?		

- If you have answered **YES** to all of the questions above, you are ready for assessment.
- If you have answered **NO** to any question, ask your trainer for help.